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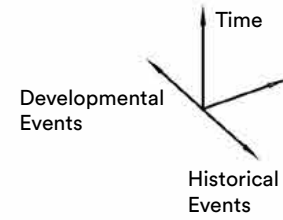
An Alumni Slope planting proposal for Cornell's campus

## 04 Sketchbook

# RECONNECTING & REGROWING SALAMANCA

Drawing from Cherríe Moraga's idea that *"the land has memory,"* the project explores how landscape can tell stories—through plants, animals, and landforms. Tasked with addressing residual petroleum contamination, the design integrates Seneca cultural elements, including traditional dances and oral histories, and employs phytotechnology to remediate the land. It envisions a landscape where ecology and heritage coalesce, cultivating a resilient and meaningful future for the community.

## SITE HISTORY | LAND HAS MEMORY



Construction of the railroad (1851–1863)

In 1848, the Seneca Nation leased land for a railroad through the Allegheny Reservation.

By 1860, the Atlantic and Great Western Railroad reached Salamanca, later connecting to New York City after oil discoveries revived funding.

First two depots and yard (1863-1904)

Salamanca's original railroad station was built in 1862, then relocated to Hemlock Crossing in 1867. Known as "The Old Ark," the wooden structure was soon replaced by a more durable iron depot completed in 1872.

Third depot (1904–2013)

In 1971, the Erie Railroad demolished Salamanca's wooden roundhouse, leaving only the fueling towers and turntable.

In 2014, the Salamanca train depot was destroyed by a 'suspicious' fire.

In 2017, four coal towers were demolished after standing in Salamanca's Erie Railroad yard for nearly a century.

Established in 2003,  
the Seneca Erie Gaming  
Corporation opened a  
temporary Buffalo Creek  
Casino in 2007, with its  
official grand opening in 2013.

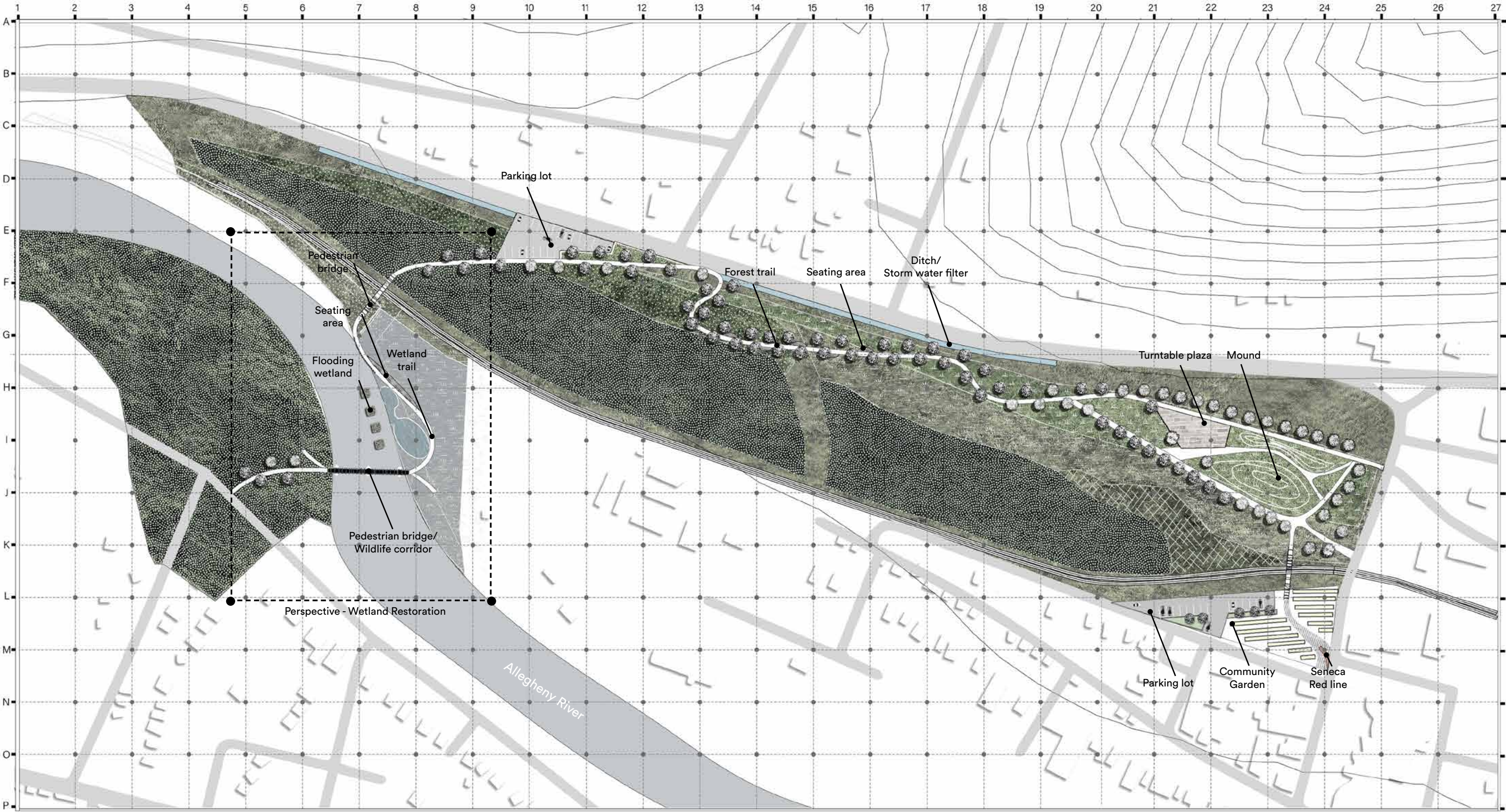
1796  
Signed on May 31, 1796, the Treaty of New York saw the Seven Nations of Canada give up all land claims in New York State for compensation.

In 1794, the Seneca and other Haudenosaunee nations signed the Treaty of Canandaigua, reaffirming their land rights and restoring territory lost in the Fort Stanwix Treaty.

The 1768 Treaty of Fort Stanwix saw the Six Nations and allied tribes cede land east and south of a new boundary to Great Britain.

In 1687, Denonville launched a major French military campaign against the Seneca, landing a large force at Irondequoit Bay.

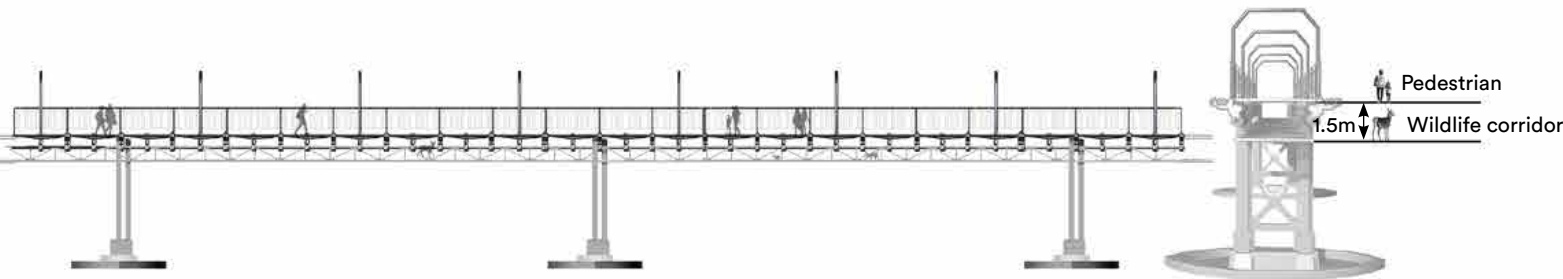
Before unification, the five nations were in conflict until a vision from Huron prophet Deganawida led to the founding of the Iroquois League through a council of chiefs and shared laws.



VIEWING PLATFORM IN FLOODING



BRIDGE SECTION



Ephemeral wetlands

Ephemeral wetlands store water during the rainy season and typically dry out by mid to late summer.

Viewing platform

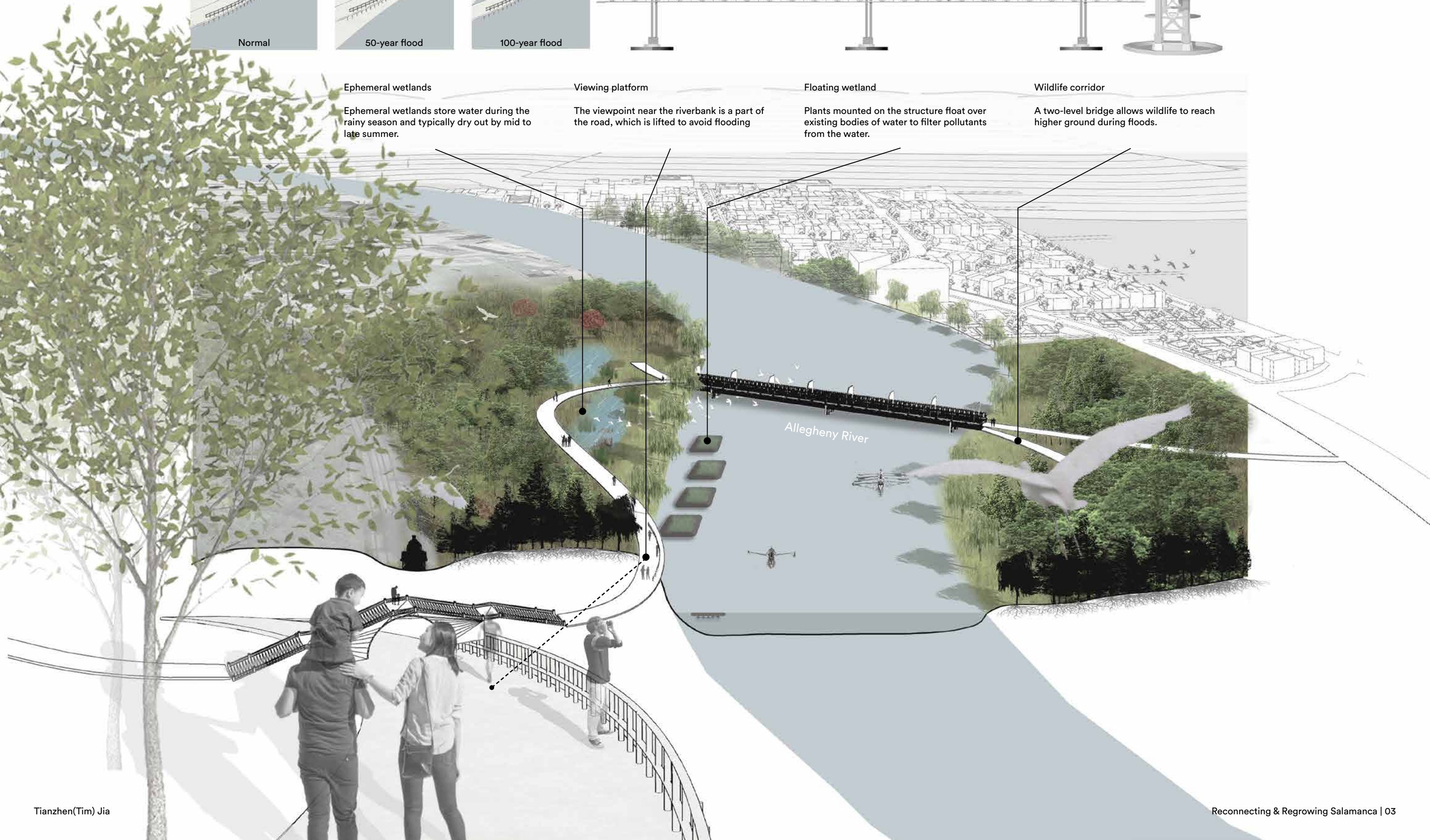
The viewpoint near the riverbank is a part of the road, which is lifted to avoid flooding

Floating wetland

Plants mounted on the structure float over existing bodies of water to filter pollutants from the water.

Wildlife corridor

A two-level bridge allows wildlife to reach higher ground during floods.



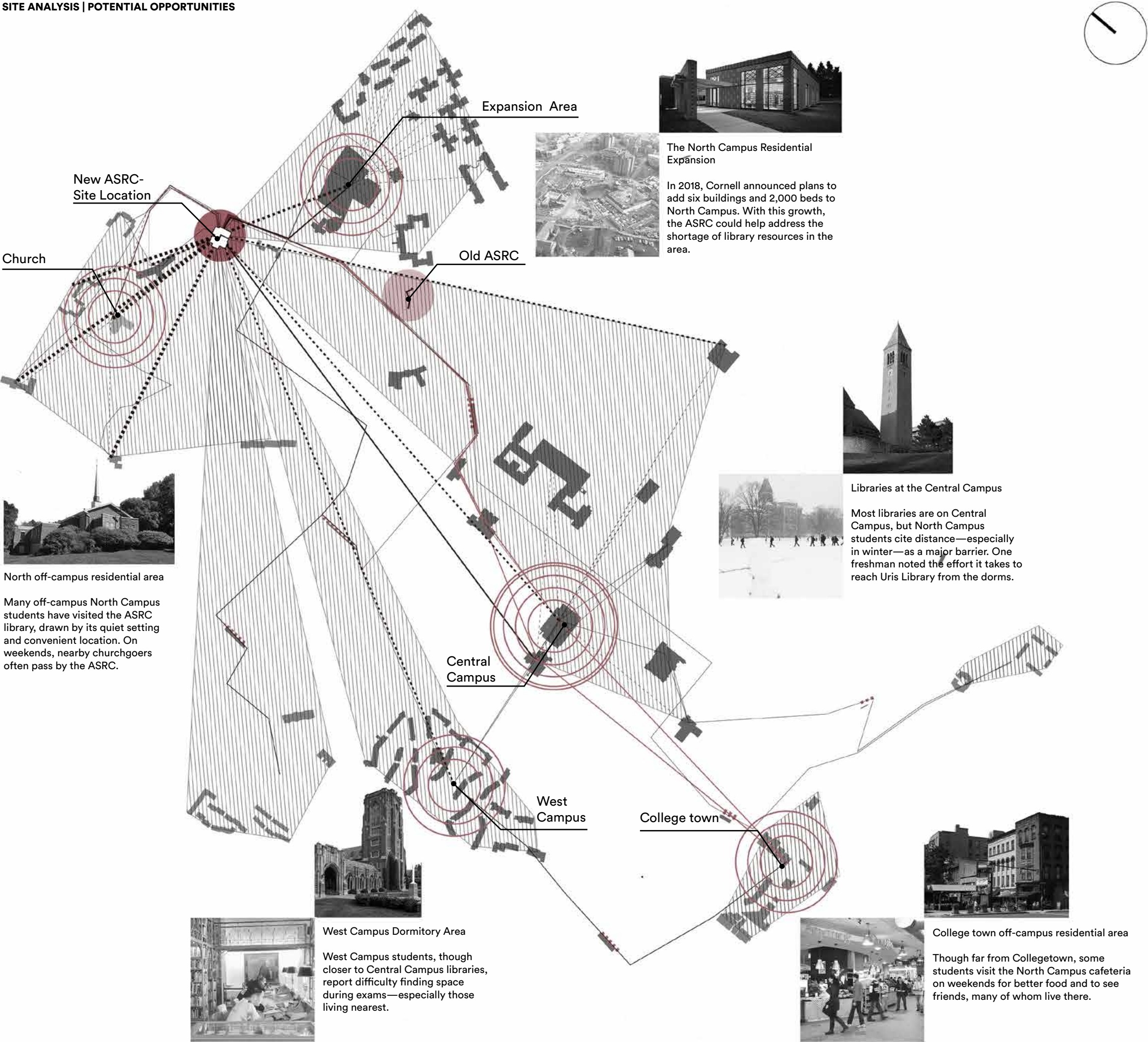
1.2

WEAVING THE FUTURE

LA 2010 Medium of the Landscape I  
Individually Designed in 2021  
Professor : Valerie Aymer (e: vea3@cornell.edu)  
Site : Ithaca, NY

History has long been a central influence in this designer's work. The Africana Studies and Research Center (ASRC) at Cornell University, though rich in historical and cultural significance, remains underrecognized despite its potential.

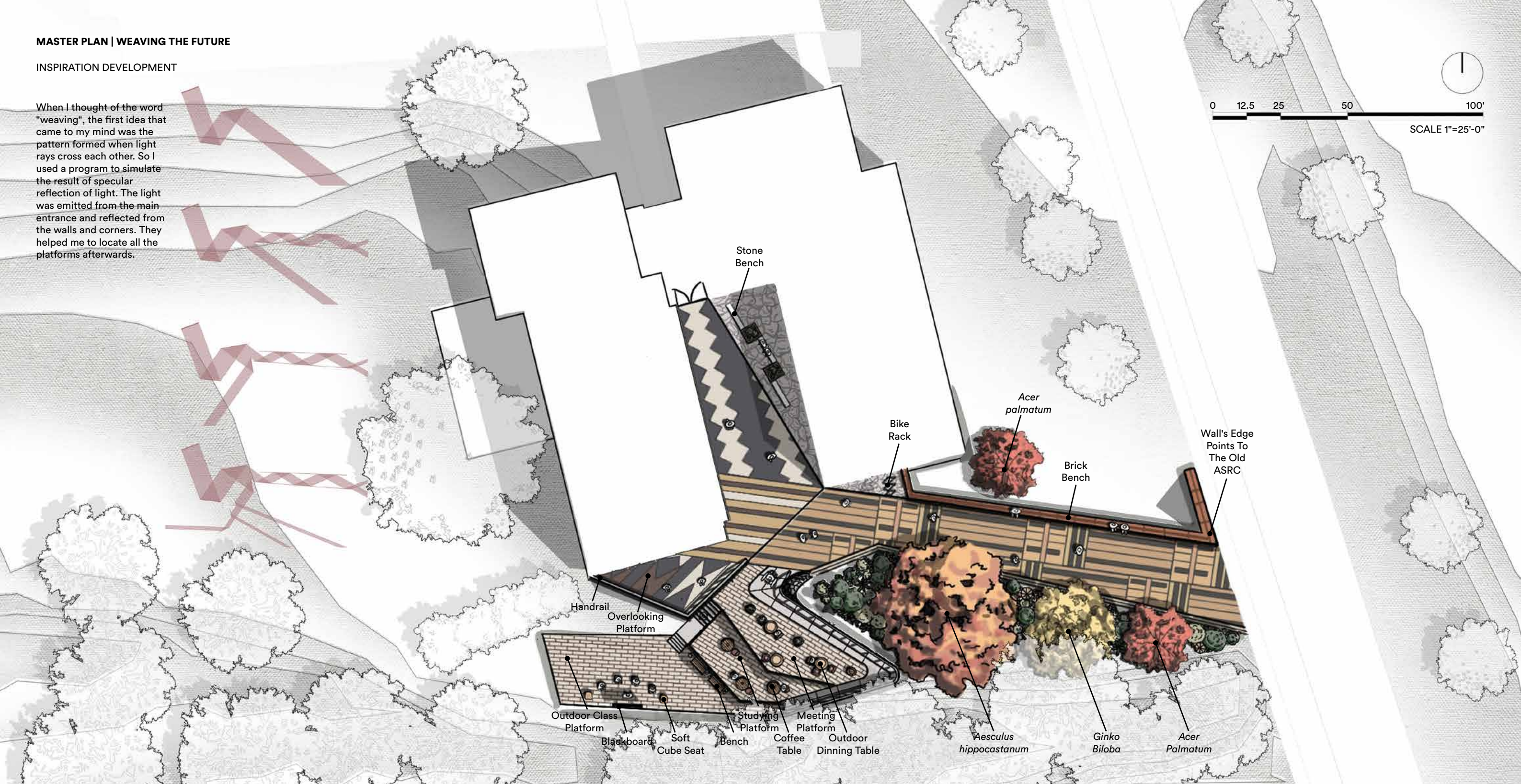
This project proposes a landscape renovation for the ASRC, drawing inspiration from African fabric weaving and the symbolic layering of light. These metaphors guide an exploration of cultural connection, spatial function, and historical memory. The design emphasizes continuity between the original ASRC—destroyed by arson—and the current site, reinforcing a narrative of resilience. At the same time, it anticipates the rapid expansion of Cornell's North Campus, ensuring the space evolves to meet the needs of a growing student body.



MASTER PLAN | WEAVING THE FUTURE

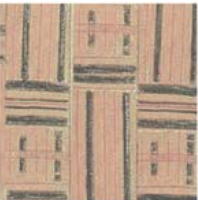
INSPIRATION DEVELOPMENT

When I thought of the word "weaving", the first idea that came to my mind was the pattern formed when light rays cross each other. So I used a program to simulate the result of specular reflection of light. The light was emitted from the main entrance and reflected from the walls and corners. They helped me to locate all the platforms afterwards.



FLOOR TILE PAINTING

Inspired by African fabrics, the ASRC renovation references Kente cloth patterns. A proposed floor tile painting scheme allows the tiles to reflect these textiles on special occasions, adding both cultural and aesthetic value.



WOFRO-DUA PAA-NA YEPIA WO

Means "one who climbs a tree worth climbing gets the help deserved."



ABUSUA YE DOM

Means "the extended family is a force."

Tianzhen(Tim) Jia

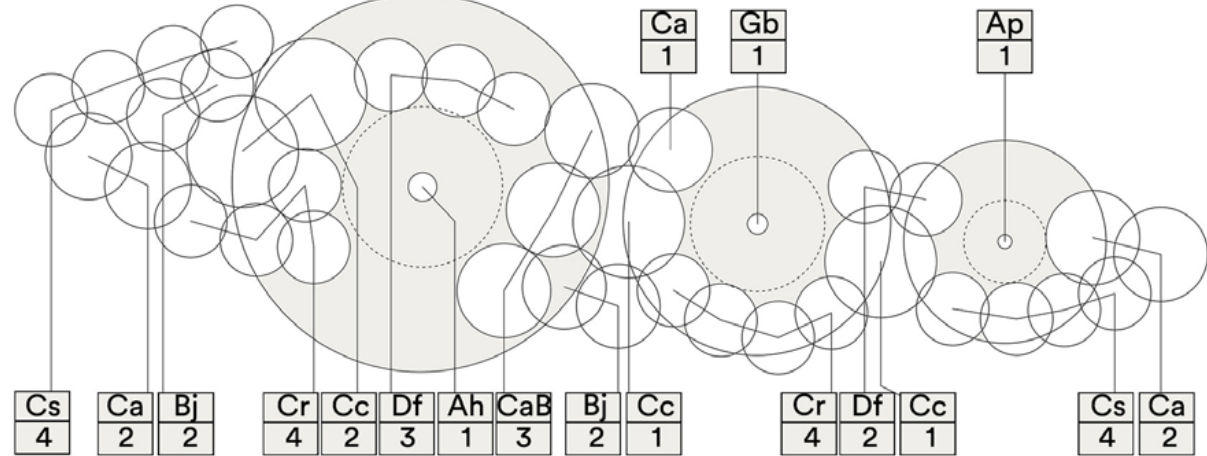
PLANT SELECTION

| No                   | Key     | Spread | Botanical name                   | Common name          | Root  |
|----------------------|---------|--------|----------------------------------|----------------------|-------|
| Small shrubs (<4')   |         |        |                                  |                      |       |
| 5 Df                 | 9"-12"  |        | Desiphora fruticosa 'Elizabeth'  | Shrubby Cinquefoili  | Cont. |
| Medium shrubs (4-8') |         |        |                                  |                      |       |
| 8 Cs                 | 9"-12"  |        | Cytisus scoparius 'Burkwoodii'   | Scotch Broom         | Cont. |
| 8 Cr                 | 9"-12"  |        | Cornus racemosa 'Huron'          | Gray Dogwood         | Cont. |
| Large shrubs (>8')   |         |        |                                  |                      |       |
| 4 Bj                 | 9"-12"  |        | Berberis julianae 'Spring Glory' | Wintergreen Barberry | Cont. |
| 3 CaB                | 12"-15" |        | Cornus alba 'Baileyi'            | Red Twig Dogwood     | Cont. |
| 3 Cc                 | 24"-30" |        | Cotinus coggygria 'Flame'        | Smokebush            | Cont. |

| No    | Key        | Spread | Botanical name                           | Common name          | Root  |
|-------|------------|--------|------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------|
| Trees |            |        |                                          |                      |       |
| 2 Ap  | 1.75"-2.0" |        | Acer palmatum 'Atropurpureum'            | Japanese Maple       | B&B   |
| 1 Gb  | 2.0"-2.5"  |        | Ginkgo biloba 'Autumn Gold'              | Ginkgo               | B&B   |
| 1 Ah  | 2.5"-3.0"  |        | Aesculus hippocastanum 'Baumani'         | Common Horsechestnut | B&B   |
| Grass |            |        |                                          |                      |       |
| 4 CaK | 12"-15"    |        | Calamagrostis x Foerster 'Karl Foerster' | Feather Reed Grass   | Cont. |

Plant species tolerant of both acidic and alkaline soils were selected due to the presence of nearby Norway maples. Bright red, orange, and yellow cultivars complement the building and floor tile colors, providing lasting visual interest.

PLANTING PLAN



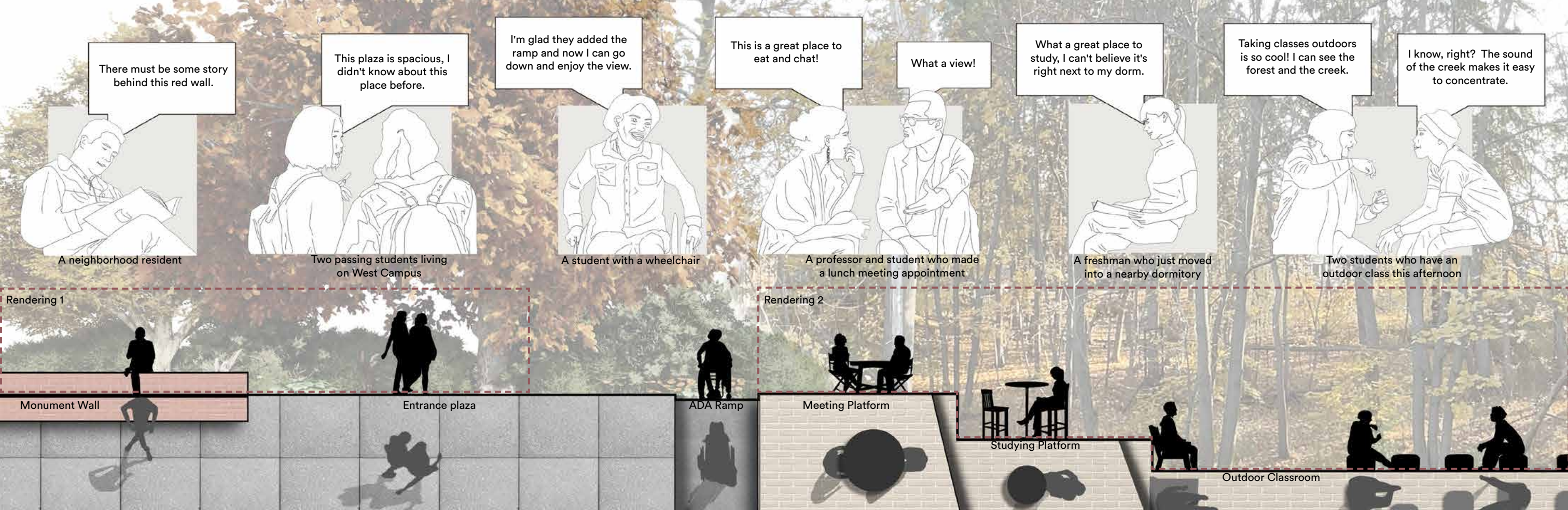
RENDERING 1 | FRONT ENTRANCE



RENDERING 2 | OVERLOOK



SECTION | USER EXPERIENCE ANALYSIS



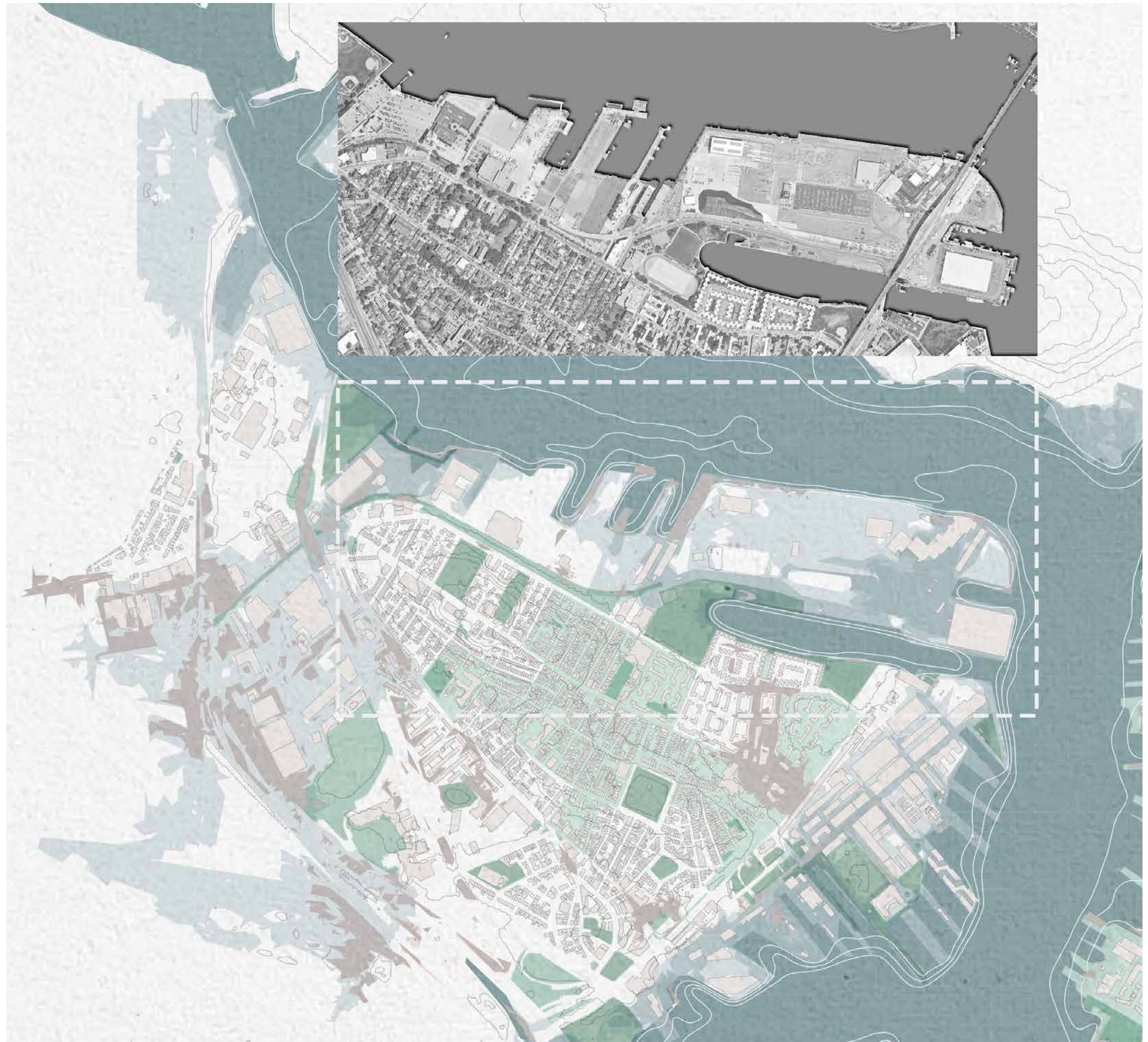
## 1.3

# PARK-ing Parking

STU-1212 Landscape Architecture IV  
Individually Designed in 2024  
Professor: Belinda Tato  
(e: btato@gsd.harvard.edu, t: 929.424.1980)  
Site : Charlestown, MA

PARK-ing Parking reimagines the northern edge of Charlestown, transforming an impermeable industrial zone into a resilient, adaptive landscape. Currently designated as a Designed Port Area, the Boston Autoport is inaccessible to the public and increasingly vulnerable to sea-level rise, placing both ecological and economic futures at risk.

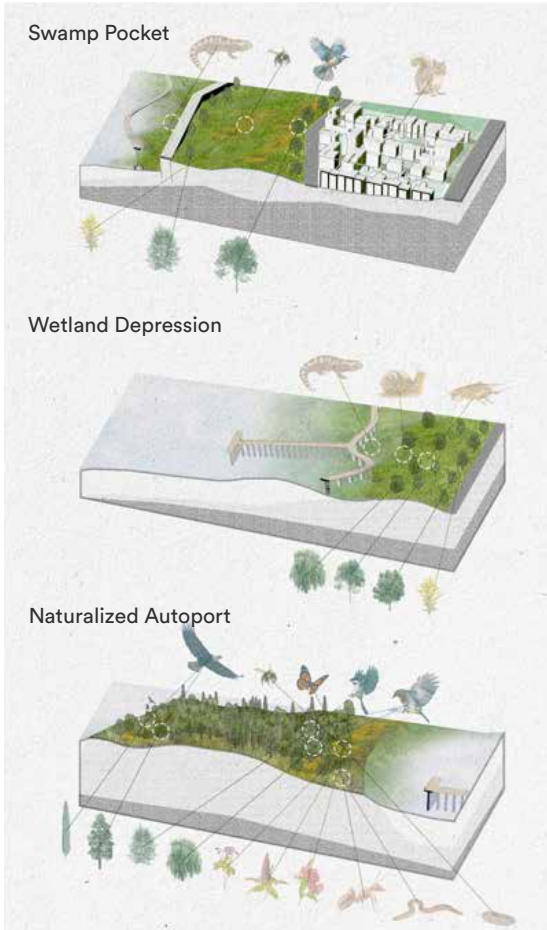
Recognizing climate change as a driver of necessary transformation, the project calls for a reexamination of the Autoport's role and function. Through strategies such as wetland depressions, "swamp pockets," and gradual landscape naturalization, the design reduces flood risks while restoring public access to the waterfront. Ultimately, it envisions a safer, greener Charlestown—one where ecology, economy, and community resilience are interwoven.



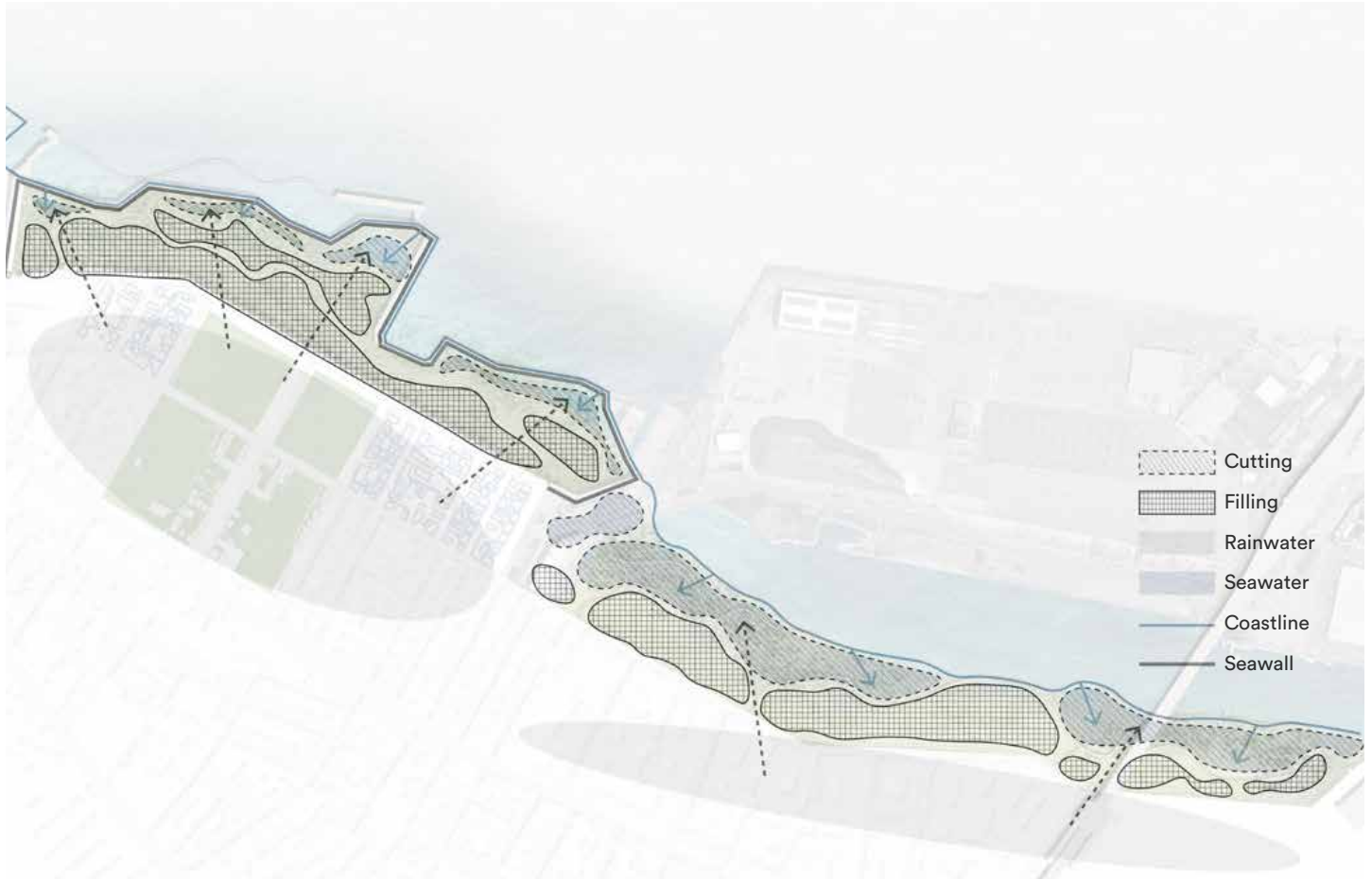
## DESIGN CONCEPT | CUT & FILL

## CONCEPTUAL MODEL

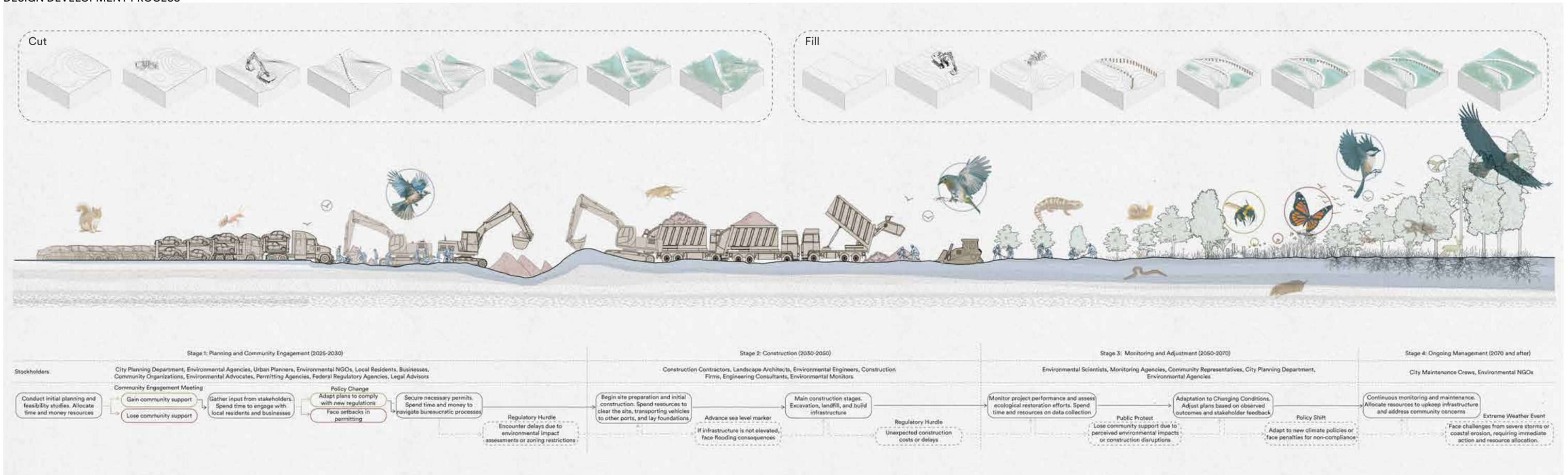
## DESIGN TOOLKIT



## CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT



## DESIGN DEVELOPMENT PROCESS



INFILTRATION & ELEVATION

RENDERING



PHASE 1 - PLANNING AND PREPARATION



PHASE 2 - RELOCATION OF CRITICAL NEIGHBORHOODS



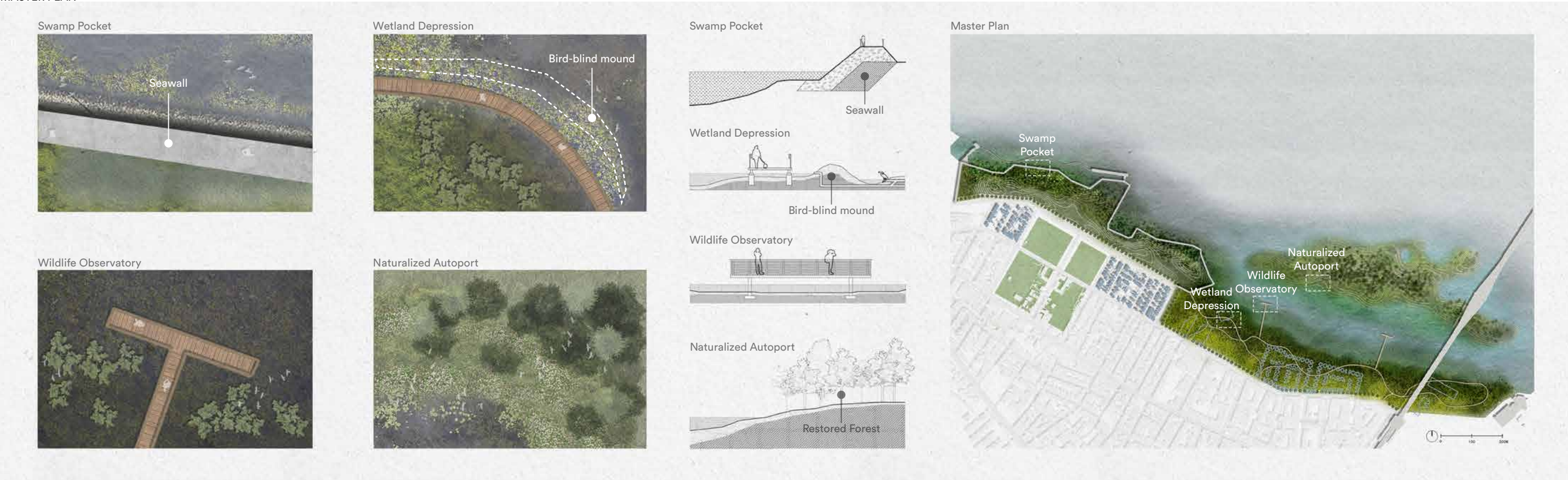
PHASE 3 - CONSTRUCTION OF RESILIENT LANDSCAPES



PHASE 4 - RESTORED NATURE AND ECOSYSTEMS



MASTER PLAN



PROFESSIONAL WORK

2.1 - PLANNING SCALE

EVERGREEN CAPITAL  
HUIDONG HEALTH CARE PROJECT

987 - acre site with a \$370 million investment that combines hospital, apartment, hotel, commercial center, classroom buildings, parks, and more  
Individually designed and rendered  
Site: Huidong, China  
ATAL Architecture & Landscape Design CO.Ltd.Shenzhen

THE GENTILLY RESILIENCE DISTRICT

A federally funded \$141.2 million initiative to transform New Orleans' flood-prone Gentilly neighborhood through resilient, water-sensitive urban design.  
Collaborators: Collin Moosbrugger, John Kleinschmidt  
Individually rendered  
Site: New Orleans, US  
Waggoner & Ball

2.2 - COMMERCIAL SCALE

ROMANTIC BAY

A seaside resort surrounded by mountains, with front-line architectural styles and techniques such as rooftop planting.  
Collaborators: Woods Bagot, Ivy Wong  
Individually rendered  
Site: Saudi Arabia  
EDSA

HONGFA KAIYUAN PLAZA

A culturally rooted residential landscape project that reimagines community space in a rapidly developing town.  
Individually rendered  
Site: Dongguan, China  
ATAL Architecture & Landscape Design CO.Ltd.Shenzhen

2.3 - RESIDENTIAL SCALE

TAI-CHI SQUARE

A residents activity plaza in an apartment complex held by Huijing Holdings  
Individually designed and rendered  
Site: Shenzhen, China  
ATAL Architecture & Landscape Design CO.Ltd.Shenzhen

DUFFY FIELD COMMUNITY IMPROVEMENT PROJECT

A community-driven park redesign project aiming to address water-logging by creating a flood-adaptive, wetland-inspired landscape where water and people can coexist.  
Collaborators: John Kleinschmidt  
Individually rendered  
Site: New Orleans, US  
Waggoner & Ball

DISTRICT ONE

A desert-responsive streetscape redesign that strengthens community connectivity by integrating native planting.  
Collaborators: Summer Xia  
Individually rendered  
Site: Saudi Arabia  
EDSA

PROFESSIONAL WORK | PLANNING SCALE

EVERGREEN CAPITAL  
HUIDONG HEALTH CARE PROJECT

After an initial meeting and review of the clients' hand-drawn sketches, I developed the bird's-eye view and bubble diagram for the project. Due to the urgency of securing land development approval from the government, the timeline was highly compressed. I completed the design within three days, incorporating client feedback to refine the final presentation to their satisfaction.

Client's Sketch



# THE GENTILLY RESILIENCE DISTRICT

The Gentilly Resilience District is a \$141.2 million initiative led by the City of New Orleans through the National Disaster Resilience Competition. The project reflects Waggonner & Ball's Living with Water approach, aiming to turn water from a threat into an asset. During my internship, I spent a month collaborating on flood resilience strategies and design plans across New Orleans, and led the concept design for the Pontchartrain lakefront, reimagining it as a flexible, flood-adaptive public space.



# HONGFA KAIYUAN PLAZA

Hongfa Kaiyuan Plaza is an apartment landscape project located in Dongkeng Town, situated in the central region of Dongguan, Guangdong Province, China. Dongkeng is a town known for its rich traditional culture and is currently undergoing rapid urban development. In this project, I assisted the design team by modifying site plans in CAD, developing multiple design iterations, and rendering visuals in Photoshop to support the presentation and refinement of design concepts.



## ROMANTIC BAY

Romantic Bay is a planned hotel development located in Saudi Arabia. My role involved creating client-facing renderings based on CAD drawings provided by our collaborating architectural firm. Throughout the process, I conducted extensive research on the region's unique topography and native vegetation. During the presentation, the clients were impressed by the quality and detail of the renderings.



# TAI-CHI SQUARE

After many communications and modifications with the client, I designed and modeled a rectangular park installed in the living area. I was the sole designer in charge of this project and I asked for advice from other colleagues during the design process. What I learned the most in this project is that a professional designer should have innovative ideas while paying attention to feasibility . Feasibility does not limit the development of design, on the contrary, it deepens the dimension of design and makes it more practical.



# Duffy Field community improvement project

The Duffy Field community reached out to us and expressed their desire to address water logging issues and transform their park into an place where water can coexist with people. As part of my responsibilities, I communicated with the client and created hand drawings to illustrate the envisioned outcomes. Through several iterations, the client showed great interest in my final design proposal, which creates a space where water and pedestrians intertwine. This design allows the site to adapt to flooding while providing a landscape reminiscent of a wetland.



# DISTRICT ONE

District One is a residential project in Saudi Arabia. Our work involved redesigning the surrounding roads and improving connections between the community and its context. I was responsible for plant selection and developing design strategies tailored to different road types. Taking the desert environment into account, I preserved the natural landscape along the road edges. I also used paving and vegetation to bridge the private neighborhood spaces with the public road areas.



INDIVIDUAL DESIGN PROJECT

**3.1 BAMBOO GARDEN**  
Final project for LA4100 (Computer Applications in Landscape Architecture)  
Individually designed in 2021  
Site: Guangzhou, China  
Constructed in December 2021  
Professor: Valerie Aymer (e: vea3@cornell.edu)

**3.2 RETROFIT AND RECONNECT: ALUMNI SLOPE PLANTING DESIGN**  
Final project for LA4910 (Creating the Urban Eden: Woody Plant Selection, Design, and Landscape Establishment)  
Site: Ithaca, NY  
Professor: Nina Lauren Bassuk (e: nlb2@cornell.edu)

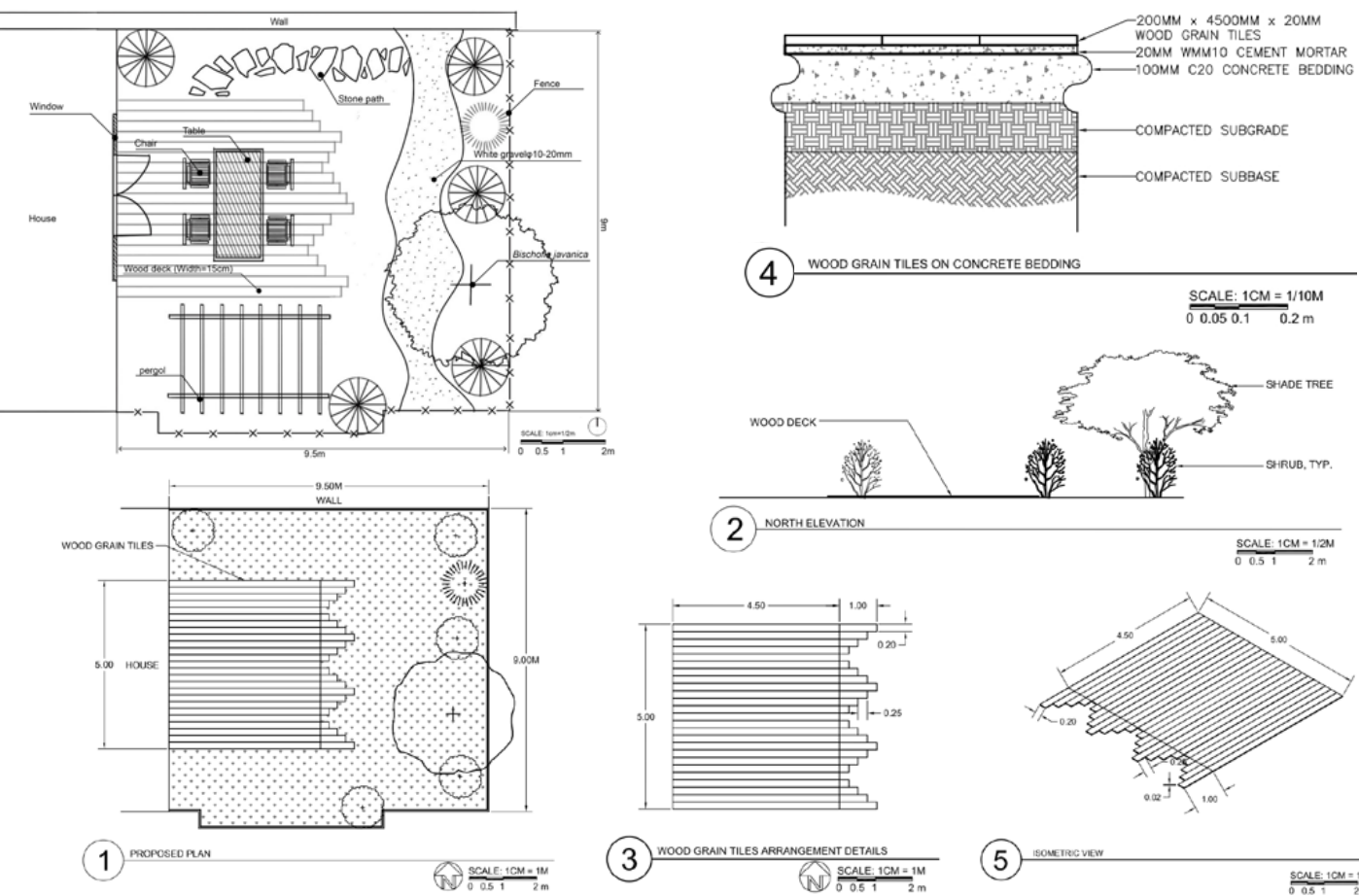
INDIVIDUAL DESIGN PROJECT | BAMBOO GARDEN

The bamboo garden was a commissioned project for a friend in China who converted a villa yard into a tea club. To preserve privacy and aesthetics, existing bamboo was retained. Two design options were proposed—Japanese and Suzhou garden styles. The final design, inspired by Japanese Karesansui and gravel symbolism, was chosen and completed in late 2021 after six months of construction. It also served as the my final project for an AutoCAD course.

Sketches done in front of the client



CONSTRUCTION DRAWINGS



CONSTRUCTION RECORDS



INDIVIDUAL DESIGN PROJECT | ALUMNI SLOPE PLANTING DESIGN

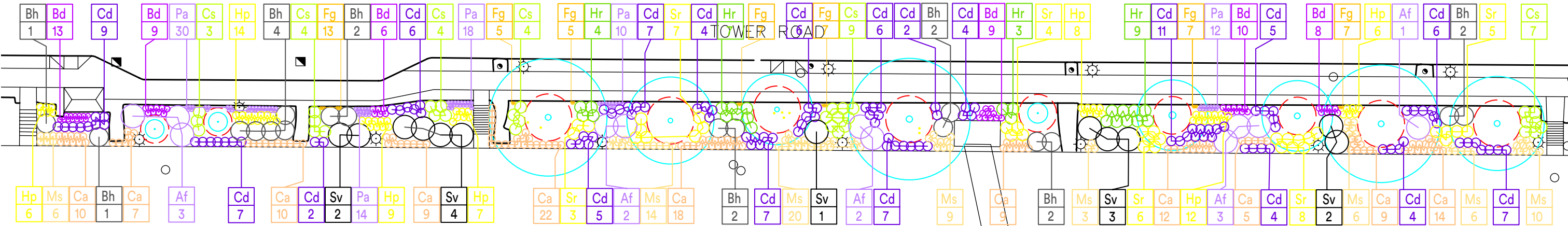
As a final project for a plant science class, the Alumni Slope design uses plant height and layering to screen the parking lot and enhance visual interest. Species were chosen for seasonal color, ecological function, and site conditions—shade-tolerant plants under trees and salt-tolerant species near the road.

PLANTING KEY

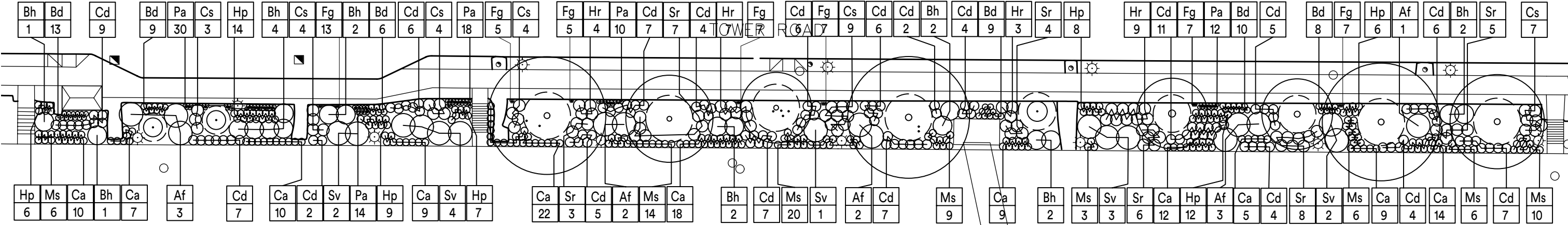
| Light                     | No  | Key | Height  | Spread  | Botanical name                             | Common name           | Comment                                                                                                | Bloom time and color |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           | Foliage                                                            | Fall color | Attracts | Tolerate |
|---------------------------|-----|-----|---------|---------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------|----------|
|                           |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        | Jan                  | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul | Aug | Oct | Sep | Nov | Dec                       |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Large shrubs >8feet       |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 14  | Bh  | 8'-10'  | 8'-10'  | Baccharis halimifolia 'White Caps'         | Eastern Baccharis     | -compact, upright form; bluish foliage; heavier fruit production, female                               |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds, Butterflies        | Clay Soil, Dry Soil, Wet Soil, Shallow-Rocky Soil                  |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 7   | Sv  | 8'-10'  | 10'-12' | Syringa vulgaris 'Adelaide Dunbar'         | Common Lilac          | - double purple blooms; healthy foliage that expresses mildew resistance                               |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Hummingbirds, Butterflies | Rabbit, Deer, Clay Soil                                            |            |          |          |
| Full sun, Part shade      | 3   | Af  | 10'-12' | 10'-12' | Amorpha fruticosa 'Lewisii'                | Desert False Indigo   | - narrow leaved variety                                                                                |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Butterflies               | Wet Soil                                                           |            |          |          |
| Medium shrubs 4 to 8 feet |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 22  | Hr  | 5'-6'   | 5'-6'   | Hippophae rhamnoides 'Sprite'              | Sea Buckthorn         | - Dwarf male, fruitless                                                                                |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           | Erosion                                                            |            |          |          |
| Full sun, Part shade      | 20  | Sr  | 5'-6'   | 5'-6'   | Sambucus racemosa 'Lemony Lace'            | Elderberry            |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds                     | Wet Soil                                                           |            |          |          |
| Full sun, Part shade      | 24  | Cs  | 5'-6'   | 5'-6'   | Cornus sanguinea 'Midwinter Fire'          | Bloodtwig Dogwood     | - improved winter stem color                                                                           |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds, Butterflies        | Deer, Erosion                                                      |            |          |          |
| Small shrubs < 4 feet     |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 58  | Bd  | 24"-30" | 24"-30" | Buddleja davidii 'Pugster®'                | Butterfly Bush        | -sterile cultivar; grows to C173 - 7' tall and 3 - 6' wide; purple flowers from mid-spring to mid-fall |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Bees, Butterflies         | Deer Rabbits                                                       |            |          |          |
| Full sun, Part shade      | 105 | Cd  | 3'-4'   | 4'-5'   | Callicarpa dichotoma 'Early Amethyst'      | Beautyberry           | - lilac fruits                                                                                         |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds                     |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Ground covers             |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 50  | Hp  | 4'-5'   | 3'-4'   | Hypericum prolificum                       | Shrubby St. Johnswort | No cultivars listed                                                                                    |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds                     | Drought, Erosion, Clay Soil                                        |            |          |          |
| Grasses                   |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 131 | Ca  | 24"-30" | 3'-5'   | Calamagrostis x acutiflora 'Karl Foerster' | Feather Reed Grass    | -Gold fall color                                                                                       |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds                     | Erosion, Wet Soil, Air Pollution                                   |            |          |          |
| Full sun to part shade    | 62  | Ms  | 5'-6'   | 3'-4'   | Miscanthus sinensis 'morning light'        | Chinese silver grass  |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Birds                     | Drought, Erosion, Dry Soil, Black Walnut, Air Pollution            |            |          |          |
| Dappled Sunlight          | 45  | Fg  | 6'-9"   | 9"-12"  | Festuca glauca 'Elijah Blue'               | Blue Fescue           | -A cool-season grass. An evergreen clumping, soft silver-blue grass to 8 to 10 inches tall.            |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           | Drought, Dry Soil, Shallow-Rocky Soil, Black Walnut, Air Pollution |            |          |          |
| Herbaceous perennials     |     |     |         |         |                                            |                       |                                                                                                        |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           |                                                                    |            |          |          |
| Full sun                  | 82  | Pa  | 18"-24" | 18"-24" | Perovskia atriplicifolia 'Little Spires'   | Russian Sage          | -Smaller more compact form of the species                                                              |                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |                           | Rabbit, Deer, Drought, Clay Soil, Dry Soil, Air Pollution          |            |          |          |



FINAL PLAN (COLORED)

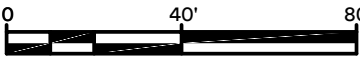


FINAL PLAN (B&W)



1

Scale 1:40



04  
SKETCHBOOK

Traveling and drawing are both my hobbies. Using paper and pen to record what I see on a trip gives me a much stronger feeling than a photograph. I looked for landmarks in different cities and drew them, which gave me a great sense of satisfaction and achievement.

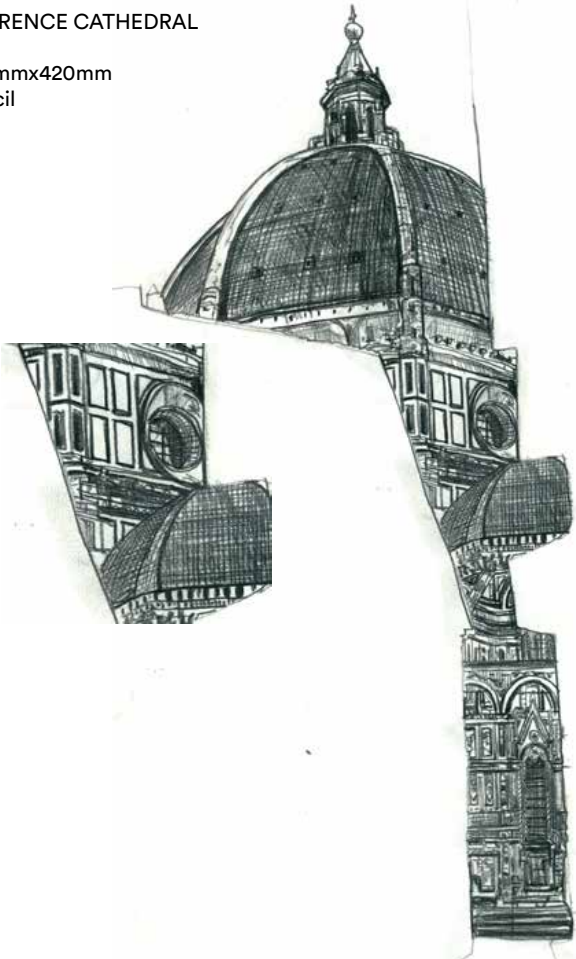
NEW YORK CITY

420mmx297mm  
Fine point



FLORENCE CATHEDRAL

297mmx420mm  
Pencil



SPAIN

297mmx420mm  
Fine point



FALLINGWATER

420mmx297mm  
Markers and colored pencils



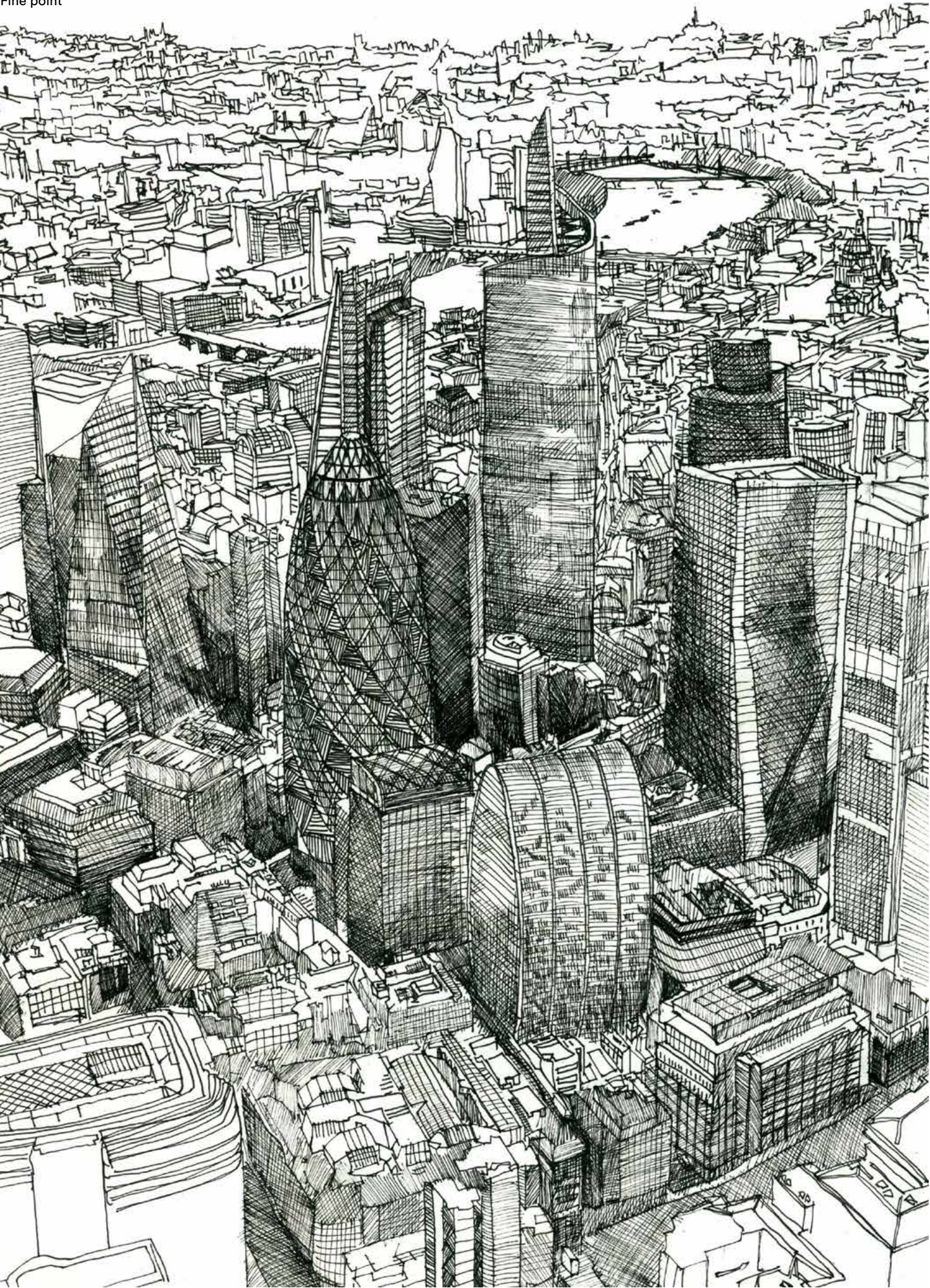
BUCKINGHAM PALACE

297mmx420mm  
Fine point



LONDON

297mmx420mm  
Fine point



NEW YORK

297mmx420mm  
Fine point

